**PEW RESEARCH CENTER NEWS INTEREST INDEX**
**JANUARY 27-30, 2011 OMNIBUS**
**FINAL TOPLINE**
**N=1007**

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| a. Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year | | | | | |
| January 27-30, 2011 | 23 | 28 | 18 | 29 | 1 |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| December 2-5, 2010: *Discussions in Washington about how to address the federal budget deficit* | 35 | 25 | 21 | 17 | 2 |
| November 11-14, 2010: *Proposals made by leaders of the federal budget deficit commission* | 15 | 21 | 21 | 41 | 1 |
| January 9-12, 2009: *Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year* | 35 | 30 | 19 | 16 | * |
| November, 1990: *Congressional and administration efforts to reach a budget deficit agreement* | 34 | 33 | 20 | 11 | 2 |
| October, 1990: *Attempts by Congress and the administration to find ways to reduce the budget deficit* | 34 | 37 | 17 | 12 | * |
| August, 1990 | 19 | 30 | 27 | 23 | 1 |
| July, 1990: *President Bush's call for higher taxes to help reduce the federal deficit* | 30 | 34 | 22 | 14 | * |
| June, 1990: *Special meetings between the Bush administration and congressional leaders to find ways to reduce the federal deficit* | 18 | 33 | 28 | 20 | 1 |
| April, 1990: *The spending and tax proposals made by Congressman Dan Rostenkowski to help reduce the budget deficit* | 10 | 22 | 26 | 42 | * |
| b. News about a congresswoman and others shot in Tucson, Arizona | | | | | |
| January 27-30, 2011 | 42 | 32 | 13 | 13 | * |
| January 20-23, 2011 | 45 | 33 | 13 | 9 | 1 |
| January 13-16, 2011 | 49 | 28 | 12 | 11 | 1 |
| January 9, 2011[1] | 31 | 33 | 13 | 23 | 1 |
| c. Anti-government protests in Egypt and other Middle Eastern countries | | | | | |
| January 27-30, 2011 | 17 | 26 | 21 | 35 | * |
| **TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| January 20-23, 2011: *Political instability in Tunisia following the collapse of the government* | 7 | 15 | 25 | 53 | 1 |
| January 13-16, 2010: *The collapse of the Lebanese government* | 4 | 11 | 20 | 64 | * |

[1] Question asked about "news about a congresswoman shot in Tucson, Arizona," and was asked on January 9, 2011, only, following the shooting on January 8.

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| May 20-23, 2010: *A government crackdown on protestors in Thailand* | 7 | 14 | 27 | 52 | 1 |
| July 31-August 3, 2009: *The Iranian government's crackdown on opposition protestors* | 18 | 23 | 26 | 31 | 2 |
| July 2-5, 2009: *News about controversy surrounding the recent Iranian election* | 22 | 31 | 23 | 23 | * |
| June 26-29, 2009: *The Iranian government's crackdown on election protestors* | 31 | 27 | 18 | 23 | 1 |
| June 19-22, 2009: *Protests in Iran over disputed elections* | 28 | 28 | 21 | 22 | 1 |
| March 20-24, 2008: *Violent protests in Tibet against the Chinese government* | 12 | 27 | 26 | 35 | * |
| September 28-October 1, 2007: *Pro-democracy protests by Buddhist monks in Burma* | 13 | 27 | 20 | 39 | 1 |
| March 17-21, 2005: *Protests and political changes in Lebanon* | 10 | 28 | 25 | 36 | 1 |
| October 6-8, 2000: *Civil unrest and rioting in Belgrade, Yugoslavia* | 18 | 27 | 24 | 31 | * |
| January 9-12, 1997: *Protests and demonstrations in Belgrade against Serbian President Milosevic* | 7 | 14 | 29 | 49 | 1 |
| d. Recent gains in the stock market | | | | | |
| January 27-30, 2011 | 13 | 17 | 20 | 49 | 1 |
| **TREND FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| August 12-15, 2010: *Recent ups and downs in the stock market* | 17 | 21 | 20 | 42 | 1 |
| March 26-29, 2010 | 13 | 23 | 23 | 40 | 1 |
| October 16-19, 2009: *Recent gains in the stock market* | 15 | 23 | 19 | 43 | * |
| July 24-27, 2009 | 23 | 25 | 24 | 28 | * |
| March 13-16, 2009 | 38 | 31 | 14 | 17 | 0 |
| March 6-9, 2009: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market* | 35 | 31 | 15 | 19 | * |
| February 20-23, 2009 | 31 | 32 | 20 | 17 | * |
| November 21-24, 2008 | 50 | 23 | 15 | 12 | * |
| October 17-20, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market* | 54 | 31 | 9 | 6 | * |
| October 10-13, 2008: *Recent major drops in the U.S. stock market* | 59 | 26 | 9 | 6 | * |
| July 3-7, 2008: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market* | 22 | 29 | 23 | 26 | * |
| March 14-17, 2008 | 25 | 31 | 23 | 21 | * |
| January 25-28, 2008 | 29 | 28 | 19 | 23 | 1 |
| August 17-20, 2007 | 21 | 24 | 22 | 33 | * |
| July 27-30, 2007 | 15 | 26 | 21 | 37 | 1 |
| March 2-5, 2007: *The recent drop in the U.S. stock market* | 21 | 28 | 25 | 26 | * |
| Early September, 2002: *Recent major ups and downs in the U.S. stock market* | 27 | 30 | 20 | 22 | 1 |
| Late July, 2002 | 33 | 33 | 15 | 18 | 1 |
| March, 2001 | 27 | 27 | 18 | 27 | 1 |
| Mid-October, 2000 | 20 | 26 | 23 | 31 | 1 |
| April, 2000 | 18 | 28 | 23 | 31 | * |
| Early April, 2000 | 19 | 29 | 20 | 32 | * |
| Early April, 2000 | 19 | 29 | 20 | 32 | * |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| March, 2000 | 23 | 29 | 21 | 26 | 1 |
| March, 1999 | 18 | 29 | 22 | 31 | * |
| January, 1999 | 24 | 28 | 19 | 28 | 1 |
| Early September, 1998 | 32 | 31 | 20 | 17 | * |
| Mid-August, 1998 | 17 | 23 | 21 | 39 | * |
| January, 1998 | 21 | 25 | 23 | 31 | * |
| Mid-November, 1997 | 25 | 36 | 18 | 20 | 1 |
| Early November, 1997: *Thinking about last Monday when the stock market dropped, how closely did you follow what was happening?* | 16 | 29 | 22 | 33 | * |
| September, 1997: *Recent major ups and downs in the stock market* | 14 | 22 | 23 | 40 | 1 |
| April, 1997 | 17 | 21 | 22 | 40 | * |
| February, 1996 | 12 | 20 | 25 | 42 | 1 |
| e. Suicide bombing at an airport in Russia that killed at least 35 people | | | | | |
| January 27-30, 2011 | 14 | 30 | 24 | 31 | 1 |
| **TREND FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| April 1-5, 2010: Suicide bombings in Russia | 10 | 26 | 24 | 40 | * |
| July 17-20, 2009: *The bombing of two hotels in Indonesia* | 13 | 26 | 23 | 36 | 2 |
| December 5-8, 2008: *The terrorist attacks in Mumbai, India* | 29 | 37 | 20 | 14 | * |
| July 6-9, 2007: *Investigation into who was responsible for car bombs that were discovered in London and a car bomb that went off at an airport in Scotland* | 34 | 30 | 19 | 16 | 1 |
| June 29-July 2, 2007: *London car bomb* | 34 | 31 | 16 | 18 | 1 |
| August, 2006: *British officials stop terror plot* | 54 | 26 | 9 | 9 | 2 |
| October, 2005: *The recent terrorist bombings in Bali, Indonesia* | 13 | 31 | 26 | 29 | 1 |
| July, 2005: *The terrorist bombings in London, England* | 48 | 37 | 11 | 4 | * |
| March, 2004: *The terrorist bombings in Madrid, Spain* | 34 | 35 | 18 | 12 | 1 |
| Late October, 2002: *The terrorist bombing of a nightclub in Bali, Indonesia* | 20 | 34 | 25 | 20 | 1 |
| September, 2004: *The killing of Russian school children by Chechen rebels* | 48 | 30 | 11 | 10 | 1 |
| March, 2004: *The terrorist bombings in Madrid, Spain* | 34 | 35 | 18 | 12 | 1 |
| Late October, 2002: *The terrorist bombing of a nightclub in Bali, Indonesia* | 20 | 34 | 25 | 20 | 1 |
| January, 2000: *The conflict between the Russian military and the rebels in Chechnya* | 10 | 25 | 30 | 34 | 1 |
| December, 2009 | 11 | 22 | 31 | 34 | 1 |
| February, 1995: *Russia's fighting in Chechnya* | 10 | 27 | 27 | 35 | 1 |
| f. Barack Obama's State of the Union speech | | | | | |
| January 27-30, 2011 | 28 | 22 | 13 | 36 | 1 |
| January 29-February 1, 2010 | 33 | 22 | 17 | 29 | 1 |
| **TREND FOR COMPARISON:** | | | | | |
| February 27-March 2, 2009: *Barack Obama's first address to a joint session of Congress* | 37 | 26 | 14 | 23 | * |

**PEW.1 CONTINUED…**

| | Very closely | Fairly closely | Not too closely | Not at all closely | **(VOL.)** DK/Ref |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| February 1-4, 2008: *President Bush's State of the Union address* | 18 | 17 | 20 | 45 | * |
| January 26-29, 2007: *Reports about George Bush's State of the Union address* | 25 | 26 | 20 | 28 | 1 |
| February, 2006: *George W. Bush's State of the Union address* | 24 | 22 | 19 | 34 | 1 |
| February, 2003 | 36 | 24 | 15 | 24 | 1 |
| January, 1994: *Reports about Bill Clinton's State of the Union address* | 26 | 25 | 18 | 31 | * |
| February, 1992: *President Bush's State of the Union Address* | 26 | 26 | 20 | 27 | 1 |

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? **[DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

| Jan 27-30 2011 | |
|---|---|
| 38 | News about a Congresswoman and others shot in Tucson, Arizona |
| 12 | Barack Obama's State of the Union speech |
| 11 | Anti-government protests in Egypt and other Middle Eastern countries |
| 5 | Projections of a record high federal budget deficit this year |
| 4 | Recent gains in the stock market |
| 3 | The suicide bombing at an airport in Russia that killed at least 35 people |
| 8 | Some other story **(VOL.)** |
| 18 | Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)** |

**ASK ALL:**

PEW.3 Did you happen to watch President Obama's State of the Union address on Tuesday night, or didn't you get a chance to see it?

| Jan 27-30 2011 | | Jan 29- Feb 1 2010 | **TREND FOR COMPARISON:** President Obama's speech about health care Sep 11-14, 2009 |
|---|---|---|---|
| 40 | Yes, watched | 45 | 41 |
| 59 | No, didn't watch | 55 | 59 |
| * | Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)** | 1 | * |